

FIFA World Cup Match Prediction Model

Team Members: Batu Akgun, Luke Hudak, Ethan LaBombard, Samarth Rao

Abstract:

The goal of this project is to develop a model that will be capable of predicting results for the 2026 FIFA World Cup using the results of previous World Cup matches. This project will involve scraping the publicly available match data; then cleaning, combining, and preprocessing this scraped data for preparation to use in model development. After the data has been prepped for evaluation, this project will advance by developing a predictive model that will take in certain statistics about the teams that are facing off in each match and use this as input data on the model that we have trained. After training this model, we hope to have a functioning prediction algorithm that is capable of predicting match results with a high degree of success.

Difficulty Level: Moderate

- **Data Collection:** The data for this project will be collected through the use of webscraping algorithms to pull publicly available match and team data from the internet.
- **Data Preprocessing:** This scrapped data will require lots of preprocessing steps to clean and prep the dirty data for use in our data mining project.
- **Algorithm Development:** We plan on writing out a datamining algorithm for use in our evaluation of the data instead of using a prebuilt library for analysis.
- **Evaluation:** We will be comparing our model to multiple other baseline methods to determine the level of success of our model.